

Elizabeth Zagroba: Leader, Questioner, Tester

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Versatile individual contributor who transcends organizational boundaries to ask the right questions, solve problems, and build software cooperatively.

U.S. citizen and Dutch permanent resident with right to work in the EU.

Work Experience

Rabobank | cooperative bank in Utrecht, The Netherlands

Lead DevOps Engineer - Test Automation

Sept. 2025 – present

Tools and technologies

Databricks, Python, pyspark, Azure DevOps, Confluence, Sharepoint

Role

- Embedded on one squad
- Supported 3 platform squads
- Lead tester for 20 department squads

Accomplishments

- Identified highest priorities for testing among 3 platform teams and 17 component teams
- Interviewed colleagues to create value stream map from ideation to production
- Derived, drafted, built consensus for, and socialized unit testing guidelines for platform squads

Mendix | low-code software platform in Rotterdam, The Netherlands

Quality Lead

Oct. 2021 – Aug. 2025

Tools and technologies

Mendix, JIRA, Confluence, Playwright, Selenium, yaml, gitlab, Miro, Python, Java, Typescript, OpenAPI (Swagger), Markdown, PyCharm, git

Across roles

- Identified & filled gaps in knowledge transfer through guilds, documentation, integration & exploratory testing, career support, leadership book club, lean coffee

Role: Aug. 2023 - Aug. 2025

- Embedded on one team rotating through the Cloud unit
- Reported to Senior Manager, Quality
- Supported 50+ teams in R&D

Accomplishments

- Promoted for ability to see the bigger company context beyond role boundaries
- Saved 150+ engineers 2+ hrs every 90 days by fixing expiring password on test data
- Paired & reviewed Typescript Playwright test automation serving Kubernetes migration
- Hired, onboarded, and coached quality analyst in implementing R&D-wide definition of done for compliance
- Created & program managed baseline EU accessibility standard for online platform

Role: Oct. 2021 - Aug. 2023

- Not embedded on a team
- Reported to CTO (acting unit lead)
- Supported 7 teams in the Data & Landscape unit

Accomplishments

- Paired to onboard junior tester to team with Kafka, C#, Go, Python tech stack
- Maintained Python script for ~20 teams to test and deploy ~50 apps via gitlab pipelines
- Built & delivered test strategy workshop to identify concrete process improvement steps
- Facilitated story slicing workshop resulting in smaller, releasable stories at refinement
- Created value stream map from data integration product crossing 7 development teams
- Organized internal conferences to share knowledge and feedback about our own products

Senior Test Engineer

May 2018 – Sept. 2021

Role: May 2018 - Mar. 2019

- Embedded on one team
- Reported to Software Development Manager

Accomplishments

- Hired and onboarded 7 people as the unit tripled in size during 2021 (amidst a global pandemic)
- Built skills in others through pairing, mob/ensemble, code review, and in mentor role
- Wrote feature-level automated API tests using the Python requests library
- Wrote several API specs in OpenAPI (Swagger)
- Uncovered risks and information about the system through exploratory testing
- Guided lean, iterative development on my team, connected work across teams

Role: Mar. 2019 - Apr. 2020

- Embedded on one team
- Scrum master and tester

Role: Apr. 2020 - Sept. 2021

- Embedded on one team
- Team lead, scrum master, and tester

Medidata Solutions | clinical trial software in New York, New York, U.S.

Senior Test Engineer

Nov. 2016 – Apr. 2018

Role: Nov. 2016 - Feb. 2018

- Embedded on one team, pairing across teams
- Level I

Accomplishments

- Coordinated with London & San Francisco teams to establish & integrate API contracts
- Pair tested with teammates, interview candidates, and on compatibility testing project

Role: Feb. 2018 - Apr. 2018

- Embedded on one team
- Level II

- Wrote bi-weekly test reports to illuminate priorities and blockers to stakeholders

Huge Inc. | digital agency in Brooklyn, New York, U.S.

QA Analyst

April 2015 – Oct. 2016

- Explored applications & determined priorities among internal, external, offshore teams
- Evangelized about mind maps for visualizing coverage and improving communication

New York Public Radio | public radio stations in New York, New York, U.S.

Quality Assurance Manager

Sept. 2011 – Mar. 2015

- Explored and tested all changes to web, iOS & Android apps from a 16-person team for million of users, including cross-domain login and platform upgrade projects
- Managed JIRA database; became point person for existing backlog and writing tickets

Online Producer

Oct. 2009 – Aug. 2011

- Juggled competing priorities for four teams/five managers; taught users new workflows

Further Competencies & Skills

- **Testing:** test automation, exploratory testing, integration testing, end-to-end testing, bug advocacy, test planning, test strategy, quality coaching, bug reporting, functional testing, agile testing
- **Software development:** GitHub, maintaining pipelines, improving code review, collaborating on architecture diagrams and decision records, troubleshooting
- **Working with people:** time management, onboarding, coaching, mentoring, pairing, mob / ensemble, facilitating, conflict resolution, communicating remotely, agile, lean
- **Native English speaker:** writing, editing, note-taking, presenting, summarizing

Professional Community Contributions

- Friends of Good Software Conference co-organizer **2019 – present**
- Blog on testing and leadership at elizabethzagroba.com **2014 – present**
- Conference speaker (complete list on [my Speaking page](#)) **2016 – present**
- Peer conferences: LLEWT, DEWT, BREWT, ET19 **2018 – present**
- Program committees: Agile Testing Days, HUSTEF, Agile2020 **2017 – present**

Awards

- Impact award, Accessibility Guild at Mendix **2023**
- Own It nomination, 600+ person R&D department at Mendix **2022**
- Excellence award, 500+ person R&D department at Mendix **2020**
- 2nd place Software Testing World Cup, North American Final **2016**
- Collaboration award, 150+ person tech department at Huge Inc. **2015**

Trainings & Courses

- System Design Workshop (Ruth Malan) **2024**
- Dutch language courses (B1 intermediate) **2018 – 2024**
- Problem Solving Leadership (Esther Derby & Don Gray) **2023**
- BBST Test Design (Altom) **2021**
- Test Leadership Workshop (Fiona Charles) **2020**
- Advanced Test Strategy Workshop (Fiona Charles) **2020**
- Python for Testers (Kristoffer Nordström) **2019**
- Getting a Grip on Exploratory Testing (James Lyndsay) **2018**
- Rapid Software Testing (Paul Holland) **2017**
- Inspired Change Leadership (Selena Delesie) **2015**
- BBST Foundations & Bug Advocacy (AST) **2014**

University Education

B.A. in Mathematics, Summa Cum Laude **2005 – 2009**
Colby College in Maine, United States

Interests

tea, biking, gardening, Dutch language, train travel, piano, puns, podcasts, moonwalking

Languages

- English (native speaker)
- Dutch (B1 intermediate)